



PROGRESS REPORT

Mauritania: progress report, August 2025 – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-26 · 62 systems and instruments tracked

Of 62 systems and instruments on this place's ledger, 32 changed position between 2025-08-01 and 2026-08-26, 16 did not, 10 carry no stated baseline, and 4 are **Not held** at both ends.

SUMMARY OF THE PERIOD · GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · DATA · GEOPOLITICS · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

Shape check, run before the comparison: 58 sources for this place in the window — 10 in the earlier half (2025-08 to 2026-03), 48 in the later (2026-04 to 2026-08). The earlier half of the window is thin: this is a shorter comparison wearing a longer label, and the movement below rests mostly on the later half.

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

Summary of the period

This was a year of things reaching service. A [national cloud](#) opened in the Tier III data centre; [four 5G licences](#) were awarded and a fourth operator entered the market; a [second submarine cable](#) completed its coastal landing; the [Ijraati](#) and consular portals launched; and [every operator switched IPv6 on](#).

Two positions moved the other way, and both are about the instruments rather than the systems. The National Digital Transformation Agenda's period ran out during this window with no successor held, and the [Universal Service Access Fund](#) was regoverned on stated grounds that its object, its financing and its budgetary treatment had never been settled. Neither the replacing decree nor the one it repeals can be read: both national gazette hosts return NXDOMAIN.

The identity layer added scale rather than reach. The register rose and the application's usage figures rose with it, and beneath both the [national public key infrastructure](#) went to tender twice extended and remains unawarded.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Ride-hailing authorisation compliance deadline	Did not exist	The road transport regulator gave ride-hailing companies operating through digital applications 15 days to bring their authorisations into line with the law, in a communique reported as published on 21 August 2026 and warning that failure within the deadline could bring legal proceedings including suspension of the activity, with no further notice or warning required; the regulator set the warning against growing use of digital platforms for transport services	ADVANCED
National Digital Transformation Agenda 2022-2025	In force, in its final years	Its period has ended and no successor agenda is held	NO CHANGE

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Startup Act	Draft bill in public consultation, targeting 300 labelled start-ups and 3,000 jobs over five years	Enacted 2 January 2024; the promulgated text is not held, but the ministry's pre-enactment deck sets out a merit-based label with a preferential public-procurement margin (Article 13), a state-backed start-up fund and guarantee fund with investor tax incentives (Article 21), payroll-cost relief and a technology-innovation hub, and IP and customs relief	ADVANCED
Universal Service Access Fund governance	Governed by Decree 2020-152 of 19 November 2020	A replacement decree approved on grounds that the fund's object, its resource mobilisation and allocation, and its integration into the state budgetary system were all unclear; the new terms are not published	ADVANCED
ANETA state digital agency proposal	BASELINE NOT HELD	Proposed by UNDP (31 July 2021) as an EPA under the digital ministry with about 50 staff, EUR 220,000 to set up and EUR 1.4m a year to run, and a draft creation decree; a June 2023 open-data strategy proposes reviving that decree to name the same body national interoperability operator; no adoption, decree or launch is on record	Baseline not held

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Data protection authority	Established, with a 2023-2026 plan	Established; no decision, register, enforcement action or annual report is held	NO CHANGE
Data protection law and enforcement record	BASELINE NOT HELD	In force since 22 July 2017, requiring APD-approved codes of conduct and free, unambiguous consent for personal-data processing, covering both manual and electronic processing; the authority runs monthly ordinary meetings and sensitisation days for ministries, telecom operators and financial institutions; no enforcement decision, register entry, sanction or annual report is published	Baseline not held

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Senegal-Mauritania digital cooperation memorandum	Signed	Signed; no deliverable, workstream or funding under it is on record	NO CHANGE

Standards

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
National framework for public digital service standards	Did not exist	Under development with German support through GIZ and the Digital-Y project; no framework or standard has been published	ADVANCED
National IPv6 transition strategy	In force, with a 25% by 2026 target and a national transition committee	In force; the target is unmet with the deadline approaching	NO CHANGE

Nothing that governs the digital estate got easier to read during this period, and one thing got harder. The [Universal Service Access Fund](#) was governed by Decree 2020-152 when the window opened and is now governed by a decree whose terms are not published, adopted on grounds that the 2020 arrangement had never defined the fund's object, its resource allocation or its budgetary treatment. Both gazette hosts return NXDOMAIN, so neither text can be obtained.

The National Digital Transformation Agenda 2022–2025 expired inside the window with no successor held. The [data protection authority](#) is in the same position at both ends — recorded as operating under a 2023–2026 plan by a foreign commercial guide, with no decision, register or report of its own on file.

What did advance is standards. The [IPv6 strategy](#) is the state's one written obligation on itself in this area, and a [framework for public digital service standards](#) entered development in March 2026 with German support and has published nothing. The [memorandum with Senegal](#) is where it was.

Finance

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Digital ministry budget	BASELINE NOT HELD	US\$24.2m for 2026, up 104.6% on the previous year	Baseline not held

MoUs and other agreements

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Islamic Development Bank digital financing	Did not exist	Agreed in principle for US\$50m covering digital infrastructure, cybersecurity, interoperability and skills; no signed instrument, disbursement or schedule is held	ADVANCED

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
WARDIP digital transformation programme	Under implementation, with the national PKI procurement and cloud build outstanding	The national cloud launched under it; the PKI procurement remains unawarded	ADVANCED
Digital-Y German cooperation project	Running from January 2025 at EUR 4m	Running; supporting the standards framework, with no output or completion report published	NO CHANGE
EIB COVID-19 resilience submarine cable financing	Committed	Committed; no completion or outcome report is held	NO CHANGE
EIB financing for the EllaLink connection	Committed, with construction under way	Committed; the cable is not yet commissioned	NO CHANGE

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
World Bank private sector, digital and human capital reform financing	Disbursed	Disbursed; no third operation is on record	NO CHANGE

Financing was where the period was busiest. The [Islamic Development Bank](#) agreed US\$50m in principle in April 2026, which did not exist a year earlier and is still not a signed instrument; the [World Bank's WARDIP programme](#) delivered the national cloud and is still running the unawarded PKI procurement; and [Digital-Y](#) and the [EIB cable financing](#) ran unchanged. The one domestic figure to appear in the window is the [digital ministry's 2026 budget](#) at [US\\$24.2m, up 104.6%](#).

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
5G licences	Did not exist; the process opened on 2 December 2025	Four fifteen-year licences to Mauritel, Mattel, Chinguitel and the new entrant Rimatel, bids of MRU 252.6m to 305m plus 5% of revenue; Chinguitel launched the country's first commercial 5G network in Nouakchott on 10 August 2026, no coverage footprint or subscriber figure published The second operator launched its network at Nouakchott on 10 August 2026 under the digital transformation minister; no coverage, tariff or subscriber figure is stated.	ADVANCED
EllaLink second submarine cable	Project launched at Nouadhibou in July 2025: 669 km, 200 Gb/s rising to 12 Tbit/s, EIB and EU financed	Phase-1 coastal landing complete at Nouadhibou, offshore laying scheduled for August 2026 and commissioning expected in the first quarter of 2027	ADVANCED
IPv6 deployment across operator networks	Adopted as a strategy in 2024 with no operator activation reported	All operators have activated IPv6, with one unnamed operator past 15% of subscribers migrated (2026-07) against a 25% end-2026 target	ADVANCED
Satellite internet licences	Did not exist; the tender opened on 22 January 2026	BRAINSAT, VDM and Mattel provisionally retained from nine bids, with VDM and Mattel required to match BRAINSAT's offer; no award, launch date or operating framework published	ADVANCED
ACE submarine cable landing	The country's only international cable	The country's only international cable in service	NO CHANGE
MEDUSA cable, sub-Saharan component	Financed, with no landing on record	Financed; no landing, route or commissioning date is on record	NO CHANGE
Chinguitel network modernisation	BASELINE NOT HELD	Completed; no coverage, capacity or subscriber figure was published with it	Baseline not held
Sahel digital connectivity support	BASELINE NOT HELD	Announced; no site, capacity or delivery figure for Mauritania is published	Baseline not held

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
National cloud platform	Did not exist	Launched to host government data and services domestically and centralise public IT; no migration timeline, capacity or cost disclosed As at 11 August 2026 the donor-funded national government cloud was in data-security testing and migration preparation ahead of go-live.	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Nouakchott Tier III national data centre	In service, operated by International Mauritania Telecom	In service; no capacity, utilisation or migration figure has been published since	NO CHANGE

Energy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
SOMELEC digital-transformation programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	A FADES-financed data-centre fit-out (launched July 2023, due October 2024), a FADES+SOMELEC-financed ERP and CRM system with infrastructure (in procurement, due June 2025), a second IDA-financed ERP study (due December 2025), an IDA-financed geo-referenced database for the national electrification strategy with server-operations training (due October 2025), and IDA-financed advanced-metering and national-dispatch studies (due October-November 2025); two telecoms engineers recruited under AfDB financing; no item is reported complete	Baseline not held

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
National computer emergency response team	Planned	Planned; no establishing instrument, staffing or premises is on record	NO CHANGE
National Cybersecurity Strategy 2022-2025	In its final year, with a CERT planned	Its period has ended and no successor, evaluation or CERT is on record	NO CHANGE
Central Bank digital reputation protection platform	BASELINE NOT HELD	Operating with AI support: more than 10,000 electronic threats detected in the first half of 2026, of which 470 were confirmed and removed, and 20 digital identities protected	Baseline not held

The cable position advanced but did not change: ACE remains the only cable carrying the country. [EllaLink](#) went from a project launched at Nouadhibou in July 2025 to a completed phase-1 coastal landing in May 2026, with offshore laying scheduled for August 2026 and commissioning expected in the first quarter of 2027 — so the single-cable exposure that opened the period closes it too. The financed [MEDUSA sub-Saharan component](#) has no landing on record at either end.

Mobile is where the market structure changed. It opened the window with three licensed operators and closes it with [four fifteen-year 5G licences](#) awarded to the three incumbents and the new entrant Rimatel, and with Chinguitel — which had [completed a network modernisation with Huawei](#) in November 2025 — live on 5G in Nouakchott from May 2026. Satellite went from nothing to a tender opened in January 2026 and [three firms provisionally selected](#) in July, with no award or operating framework.

Hosting is the clearest gain. The Tier III data centre was already inaugurated when the period opened; the [national cloud](#) launched into it in June 2026, giving the state a domestic place to put government data. No migration timeline, capacity or cost was disclosed with it, so what has actually moved onto it cannot be stated.

IPv6 went from a strategy with no reported operator activation to [full activation across every licensed operator](#), with subscriber migration in the teens against a 25% end-2026 target. Cybersecurity moved the other way: the 2022–2025 strategy's period expired inside the window with no successor and no CERT, and the only operational figure the year produced is the [Central Bank's threat-detection count](#).

DPI

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
National data management system	Did not exist	Being scoped for inter-administration integration with blockchain proposed as its trust layer, on a national blockchain policy in consultation since November 2025 naming land administration, trade, public procurement and natural-resource management; no draft text, adoption date or budget published	ADVANCED

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Biometric SIM identification	Deactivation of non-biometric SIMs ordered in October 2023, with compliance not established	Formal notices to Mattel, Mauritel and Chinguitel with a two-month deadline before sanctions of up to 3% of turnover; no compliance outcome is on record	ADVANCED
Houwiyeti digital identity application	Launched in 2024 on the TECH5 platform, carrying document extracts and passport requests	In use by about 1.5 million citizens for 554,027 remote services, and the identity-verification backbone for the state services portal's fifteen-plus services and for private financial applications; a full day of scheduled maintenance on 8 August took all of it down at once	ADVANCED
National Population Register	More than 94% of the population reported enrolled since 2020	5.1m on the register against 3.4m in 2019, with more than 1.7m new enrolments, over 613,000 captured by a difficulties survey and 238 local commissions installed; enrolment is now a permanent public service under the 2025 reform	ADVANCED
National public key infrastructure and certificate management system	Did not exist	Tendered in two lots under World Bank credit and twice extended, with evaluation reweighted to 40% technical and 60% cost; no award is held	ADVANCED

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
PAMIF financial infrastructure modernisation	Financial inclusion at 21% in 2019-20	Financial inclusion at 55% in 2026 on the financier's own account, with BMCI transfers rising from 5,000 in the whole of 2023 to 94,000 in the second half of 2025; a second phase targets a fintech ecosystem	ADVANCED
Tax on electronic transactions	Did not exist	In force at 0.1% on electronic transactions above MRU 5,000 and 10% on agent commissions, collected at source	ADVANCED

Registries

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Biometric driving licences and registration plates	Did not exist	The equipment and transport minister stated that driving licences and vehicle registration plates would be digitised and issued in biometric form before the end of 2026, alongside continued reform of the land transport directorate	ADVANCED
Unified digital consular registry	Did not exist	Live for Saudi Arabia, Bahrain and the Maldives, registering residence, geographic distribution and permitted activities and building a digital register of national skills abroad	ADVANCED

Sectoral management information systems

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Education certificate service on Houwiyeti	In service for certificates issued after 2013 or linked to the national identity number	In service; no usage figure is held	NO CHANGE

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Digital consular services platform	Did not exist	Live, delivering consular registration, the consular card, travel authorisation, legalisation, powers of attorney, appointments and burial and repatriation permits without attending the mission	ADVANCED
Digitised civil service recruitment competition	Did not exist	Candidate files filed through the state services platform for a four-day examination covering 390 civil service posts, part of a wider competition for 3,000 state employees and contract workers, run by the competitions commission with the digital transformation ministry	ADVANCED
Digitised civil-service recruitment	Did not exist	Applications filed through the Khadamaty platform and examinations sat on digital tablets at Nouakchott, for a 390-post competition inside a wider 3,000-post programme	ADVANCED
Electronic invoicing for public institutions	Did not exist	Announced, to handle VAT and withholding at source by transferring data automatically to the tax directorate; no instrument, supplier or date published	ADVANCED, ANNOUNCED ONLY
Ijraati administrative procedures portal	Did not exist	Live as a directory of more than 800 procedures with documents, processing times, agencies and tracking; no usage figure published	ADVANCED
Khdamati remote transactions platform	Did not exist	Named in a roadmap and now the subject of integration work with the Diwan territorial-administration system, discussed on 2026-08-13 with the German embassy's charge d'affaires and GIZ's resident director as part of decentralisation and local-development cooperation; no build, date or scope is published	ADVANCED, ANNOUNCED ONLY
SNDE services on the Mes Services portal	Did not exist	Live, with the utility's transactions available remotely; German cooperation was credited without an amount, instrument or term, and no usage figure exists	ADVANCED
STT electronic tax services platform	BASELINE NOT HELD	Live, with 66 public bodies enrolled, 53 filing electronically and 3 paying through it, against 642 legally constituted public bodies of which 339 are active with the tax administration	Baseline not held

Identity is the busiest layer and the one where the underlying trust infrastructure is furthest behind. The [National Population Register](#) moved from a reported coverage claim to a stated total of 5.1m against 3.4m in 2019, with enrolment made a permanent public service and 238 local commissions installed — a reform whose existence records that a residual of citizens still has no papers. [Houwiyeti](#) reported 677,000 activated accounts and 1,511,139 beneficiaries by June 2026, its share of passport requests rising through the period to 35.7% by January 2026. Against that, the [national PKI](#) went from not existing to tendered, twice extended and unawarded, and [biometric SIM enforcement](#) moved from an unenforced 2023 deactivation order to formal notices with sanctions attached and no reported compliance outcome.

Government services were consolidated rather than multiplied. [Ijraati](#) launched in February 2026 with more than 800 procedures, the [consular platform](#) in July, and the water utility was [attached to the Mes Services portal](#) in August rather than given its own. That is an architectural choice, and its value depends on how many utilities follow; none is named.

The measurement that puts all of this in proportion arrived at the end of the window. Of [642 legally constituted public bodies](#), [339 are active with the tax administration](#), and [3 pay through the electronic platform](#). No comparable figure exists for the start of the period, so this is a reading rather than a trend — but it measures the state against a system the state itself runs.

Payments delivered and were taxed in the same window. [PAMIF](#) is reported by its financier as having taken financial inclusion from 21% in 2019–20 to 55% in 2026, and the 2026 finance law introduced a [0.1% levy on electronic transactions above MRU 5,000](#). Statistics gained a first [National Youth Empowerment Index](#) at a preliminary 60.5 out of 100.

Technology

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
National AI Strategy 2025-2029	Recorded as existing, the text not held	Recorded as existing; nothing establishes its scope, commitments, budget or implementing body	NO CHANGE

ICT Industry

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Mobile operator market	Three licensed operators: Mauritel, Mattel and Chinguitel	Four, with the new entrant Rimatel licensed alongside the three incumbents	ADVANCED

The AI position is unchanged across the whole period: a [strategy for 2025–2029](#) recorded as existing by a foreign commercial guide, with no text, budget or implementing body established at either end.

What changed is the market and the partners. A [fourth operator](#) was licensed, and a [cooperation agreement with Oman](#) was signed in July 2026 covering cybersecurity, artificial intelligence and data analytics with no value disclosed. The Chinese-funded [urban security system](#) is unchanged, with no delivery or oversight arrangement on record at either end.

Capacity

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Youth digital employability programme	Predecessor programme Tech pour la Mauritanie, closed in 2025	Running for 2,150 beneficiaries across six cities, about 2,000 of them young people, financed by France's Fonds Equipe France and implemented by Simplon	ADVANCED

Research institutions

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
National digital or data research programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	Calcul Scientifique, Informatique et Data Sciences unit at the Faculté des Sciences et Techniques, Université de Nouakchott, with 16 doctoral candidates concentrated in AI and data science (5G optimisation, blockchain/IoT process mining, health-data management, cloud-resource elasticity) and three theses defended in 2022; the accreditation period ended May 2024 with no renewal published	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Data

National statistics

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Fifth general population and housing census	<i>Baseline not held</i>	Conducted entirely electronically for the first time - mapping, collection, processing and analysis all digital - with final results presented at regional workshops from August 2026	ADVANCED
National Youth Empowerment Index	Did not exist	Published in preliminary form at 60.5 out of 100 for 2026, across five domains built from 43 secondary indicators, education and training strongest at 69.5% and health and sport weakest at 46.1%	ADVANCED

Open data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
National open data portal	BASELINE NOT HELD	mauritania.opendataforafrica.org, run by ANSADE, carries 24 downloadable datasets from 4 public providers — last of four benchmarked countries (Mauritania, Morocco, Senegal, Tunisia) on every published measure — with no Open Government Partnership membership; a June 2023 strategy proposes a new governance framework, portal redesign and reviving the decree creating an Agence Numérique de l'État as operator, none of which is reported delivered	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Geopolitics

China activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Urban security system	Granted	Granted; no delivery, siting or oversight arrangement for the system is on record	NO CHANGE

Gulf/UAE activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Oman digital cooperation agreement	Did not exist	Signed, covering digital capacity-building, e-training, cybersecurity, artificial intelligence and data analytics, platform development and civil-service programmes; no value disclosed by either side	ADVANCED

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Power supply to network sites and the data centre	An operator, utility or regulator statement quantifying outage exposure or backup provision for telecommunications sites and the Nouakchott Tier III data centre now hosting the national cloud.	2026-08-10
Municipal or regional digital services	A named wilaya or commune digital service, one-stop desk or local e-government platform, with a location and a start date. Ijraati and Mes Services are national portals.	2026-08-10
IBTIKAR technology park	Any dated statement of whether the IBTIKAR technology park, named in the 2023 digital agenda, was built, is operating, or holds tenants.	2026-08-10
National digital literacy measurement	A national survey or ministry statement measuring digital skills or literacy in Mauritania, as distinct from the vocational-training place counts.	2026-08-10

None of these closed during the period. Two of them are documents that exist and cannot be reached, because the national gazette's two hosts do not resolve — the data protection law and the universal-access fund decrees. That is a publisher failure, and it is why a country with a data protection authority has no enforcement record here.

The rest stood throughout: the Startup Act and the IBTIKAR technology park, both named in the 2023 digital agenda and neither given a dated status since; no open-data portal; no municipal or regional digital service against two national portals; and no measurement of digital literacy, research capacity or the power the national cloud depends on.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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